Score

Connor Simpson

Saxophone Quartet

The Memory of a Story

15'

2022

For Perusal Only

Mere Fly Press

The Memory of a Story
Saxophone Quartet
2022
15 minutes
Connor Simpson
Mere Fly Press (ASCAP)

Program Notes

When I was young, my sister liked to pick on me as all older siblings do. On one particular summer day, my sister felt that she and her friends were far too cool to hang out with me. At the very sight of me they ran straight up the little hill in our backyard. Without knowing any better, I ran right up after them. As soon as I got to the top of the hill, they pushed me right back down. I began to cry as I tumbled down this little hill. I didn't cry because I hurt, but because I knew exactly how to handle this situation, I would tell on my sister immediately. As I ran to my parents, I could hear my sister and her friends calling out "tattle-tale! tattle-tale!" behind me. I rushed inside to find my dad hunched over his desk. I began to stutter and cry but on this day, my dad had a plan. "I know what you need," my dad said as he walked me toward the fridge. He opened the freezer to reveal a snowball resting atop a dinner plate. He told me "I made this snowball back in the winter and I have been saving it for you ever since. You take this snowball, throw it at your sister, and teach her a lesson." I ran to my sister as fast as I could, armed and ready for vengeance. I threw the snowball with all my strength, and it fell straight to the ground. But that didn't matter. That snowball — moment — was magical to me, and nothing could take away from my happiness.

Although I can still recount this story to you, I must confess that I can no longer remember that day. I can't hear my sister calling "tattle-tale" or see the snowball, nor can I even remember the house I once lived in. I can no longer remember which bits I embellished and which I made up completely. I can only remember all the times I have told this story before. Yet I still smile each time I tell this story. I smile not at the memory of that day, but of the memories of each laugh it has brought my family and friends. When I remember this story, I am filled not with the joy of a magical snowball but with the warm atmosphere of being around those I care about.

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Performance Notes

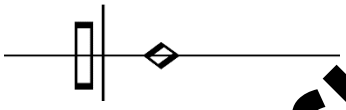
- Feathered Beams: acceleration or deceleration of rhythmic duration

- Diamond Noteheads: air through instrument

air through instrument with sporadic key clicks

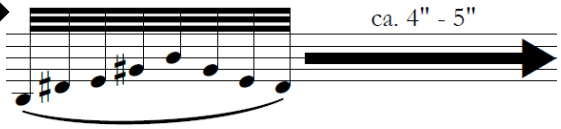
- While blowing air through instrument, forcefully and sporadically press keys

(with key clicks)



- (with key clicks): abbreviation of above technique

- White Circle: a tone consisting of only air, Black Circle: a full tone free of air, a line represents a gradual transition between techniques



- Thick line within the staff, continue gesture for specified duration

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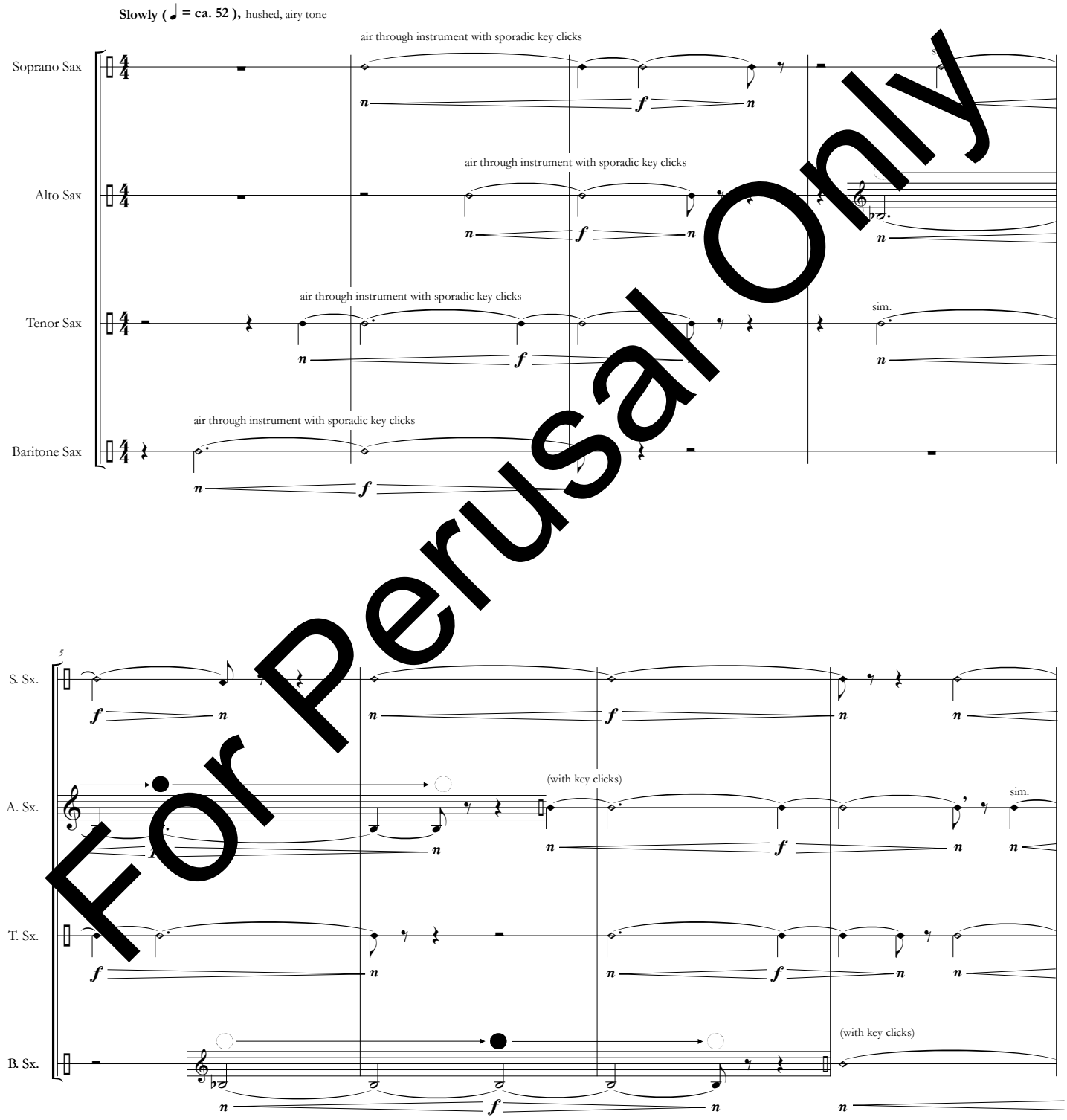
Score

the Memory of a Story

Connor Simpson



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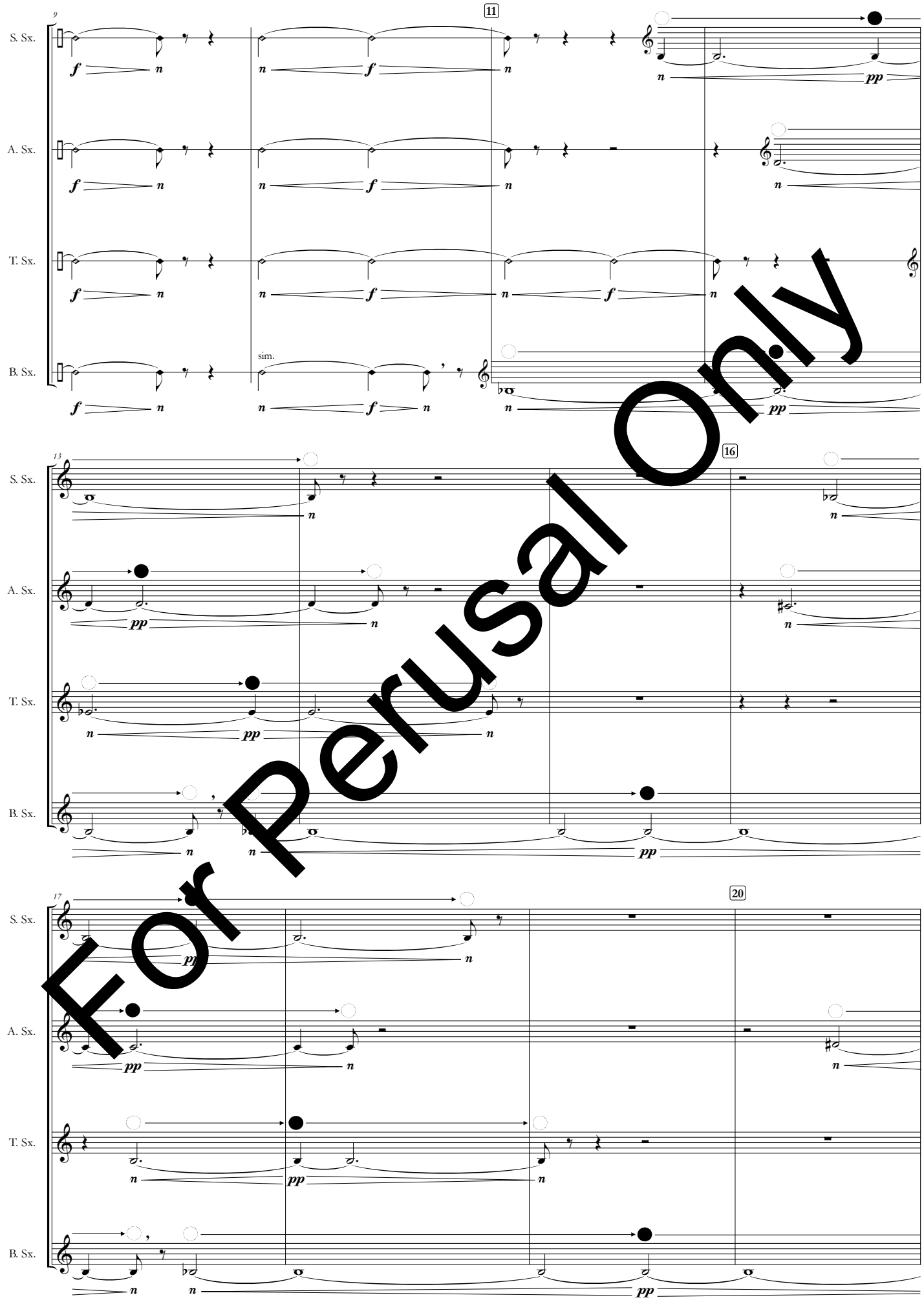

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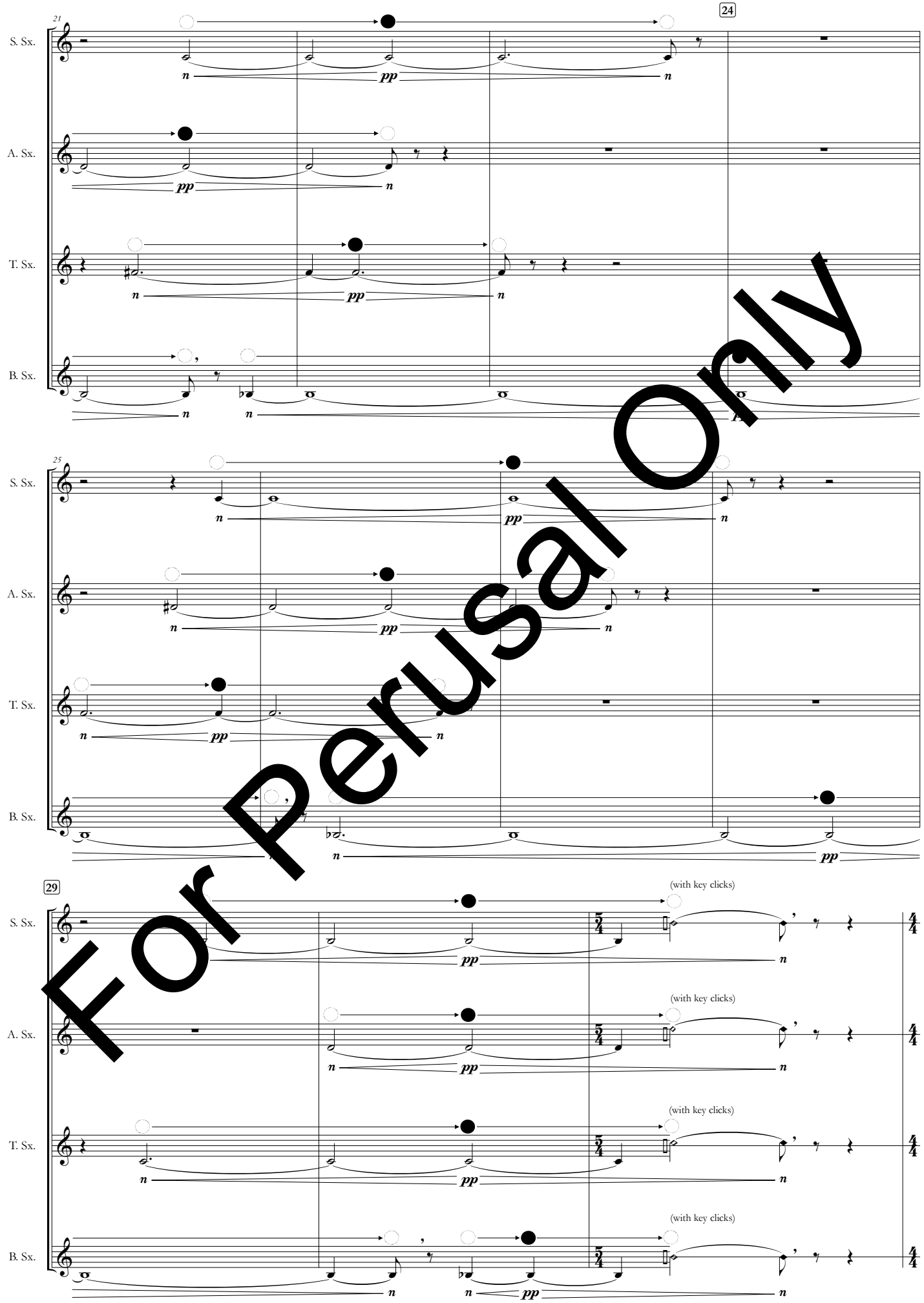

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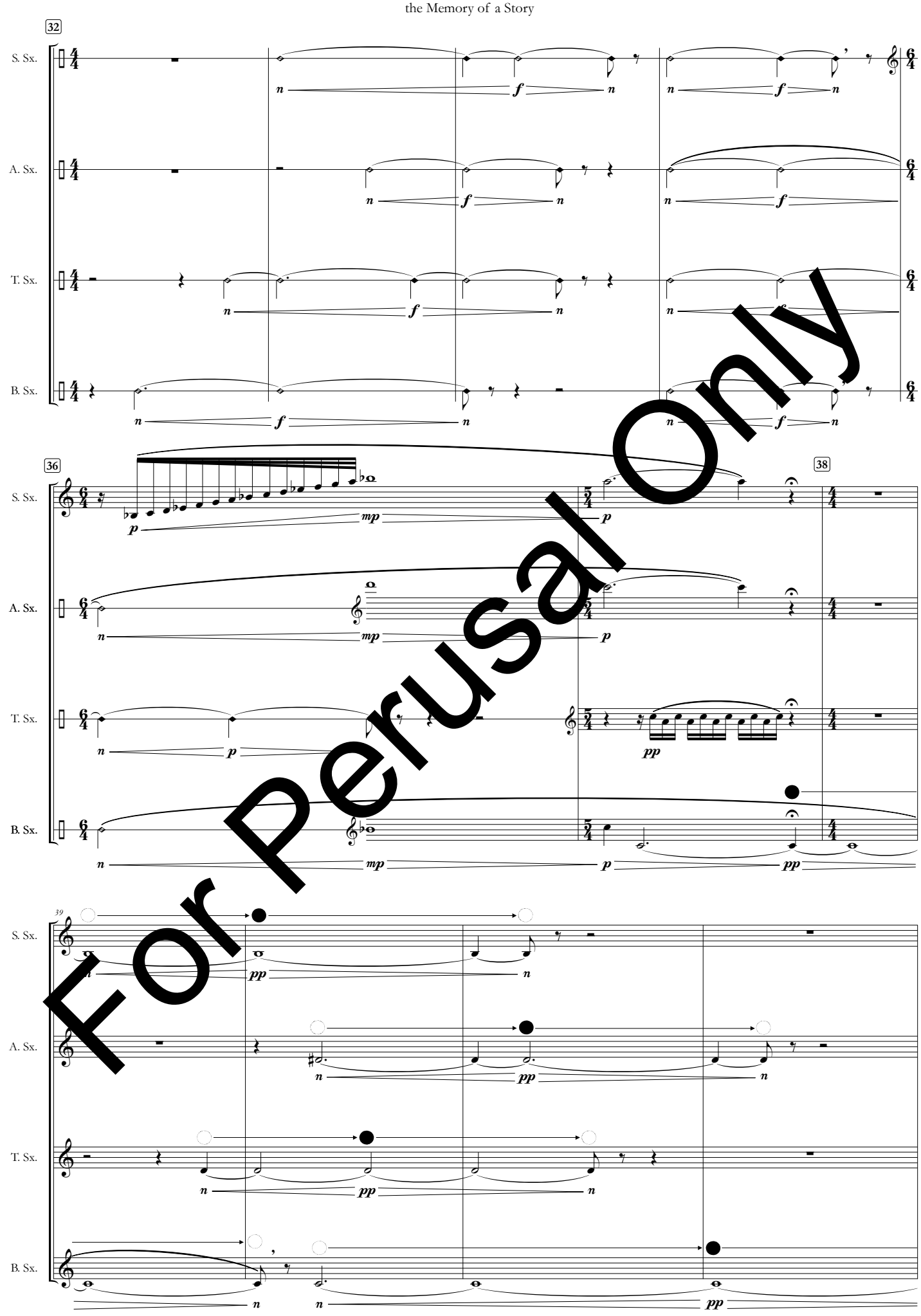
32
S. Sx.
A. Sx.
T. Sx.
B. Sx.
36
38
39
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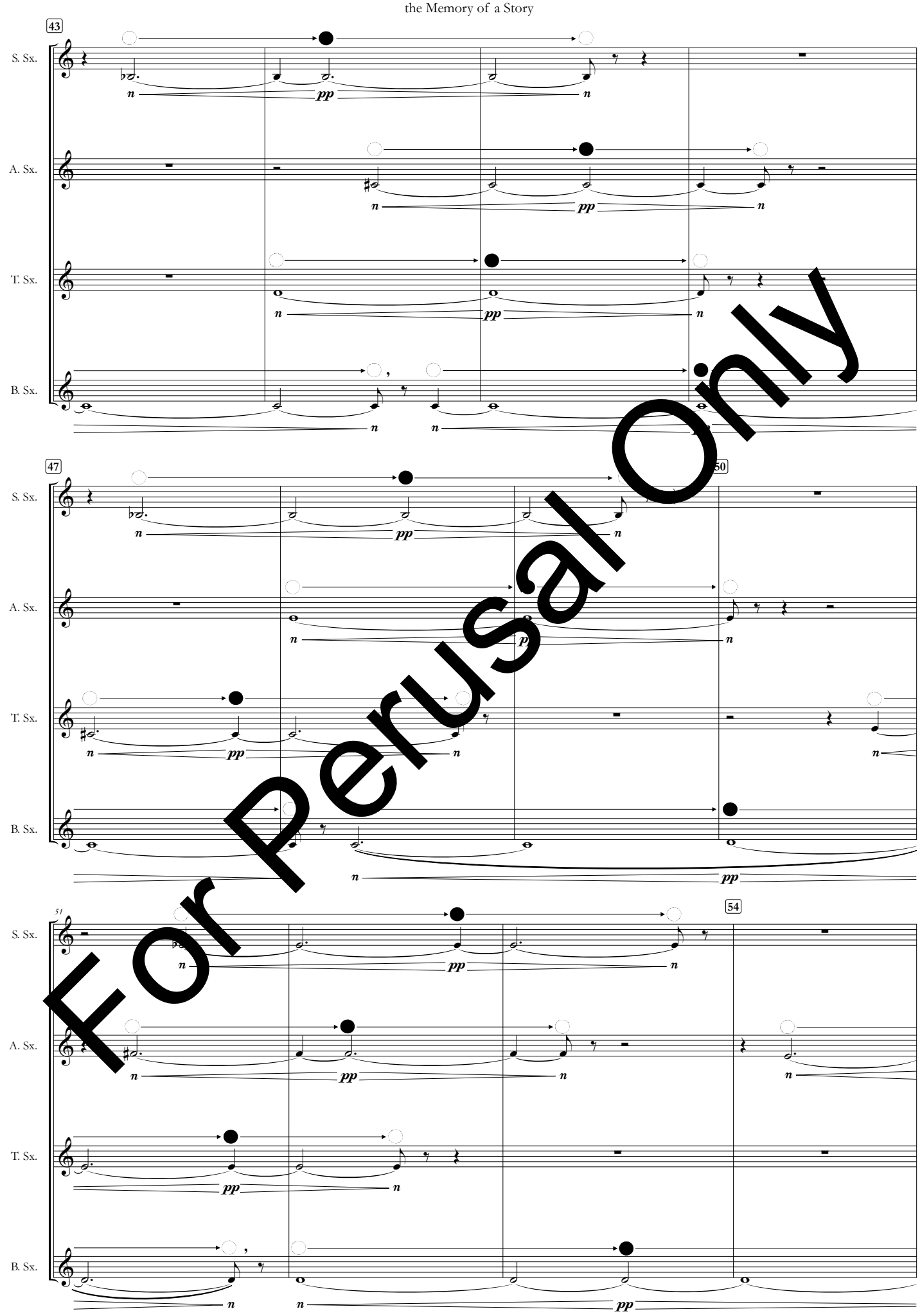

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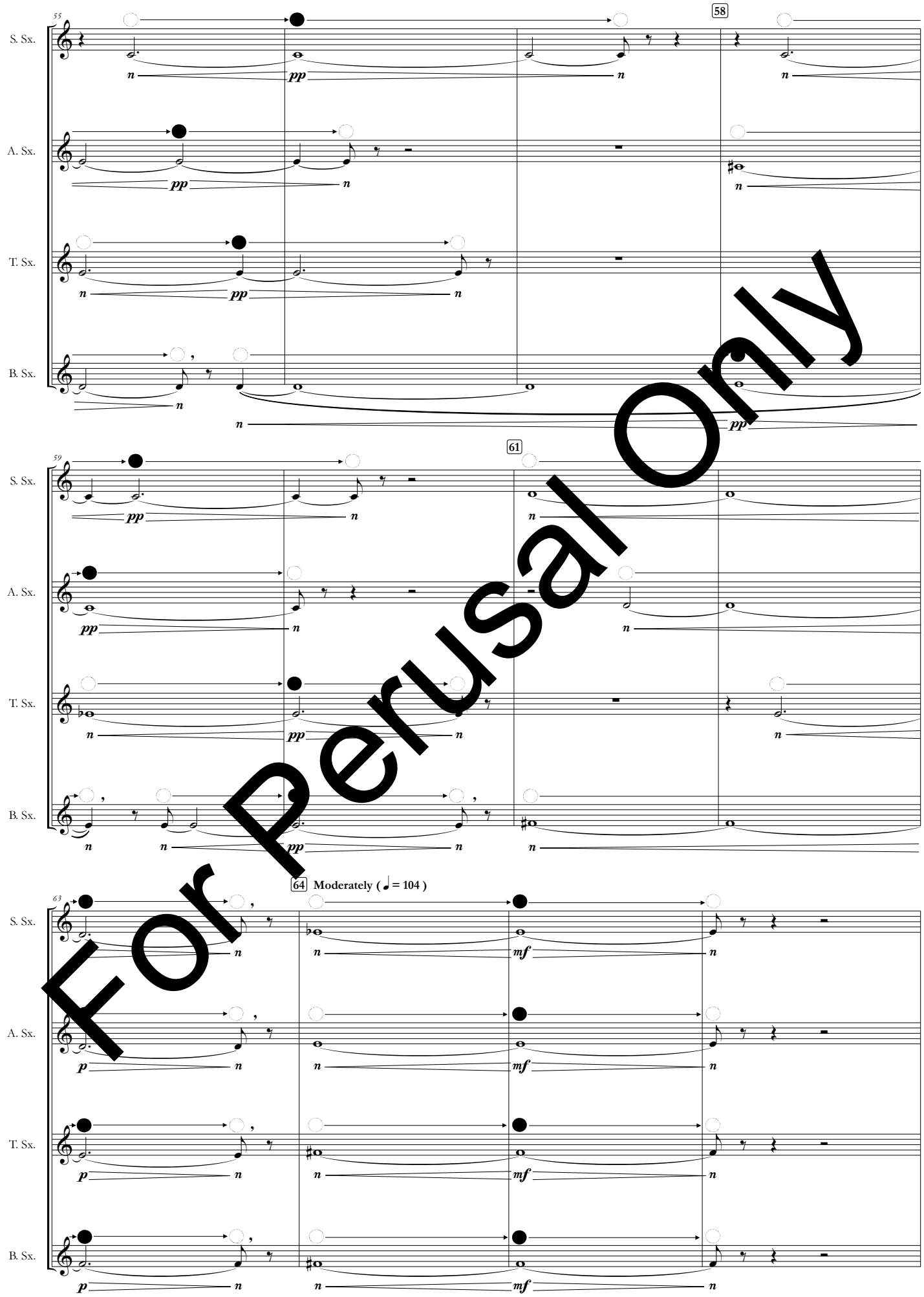

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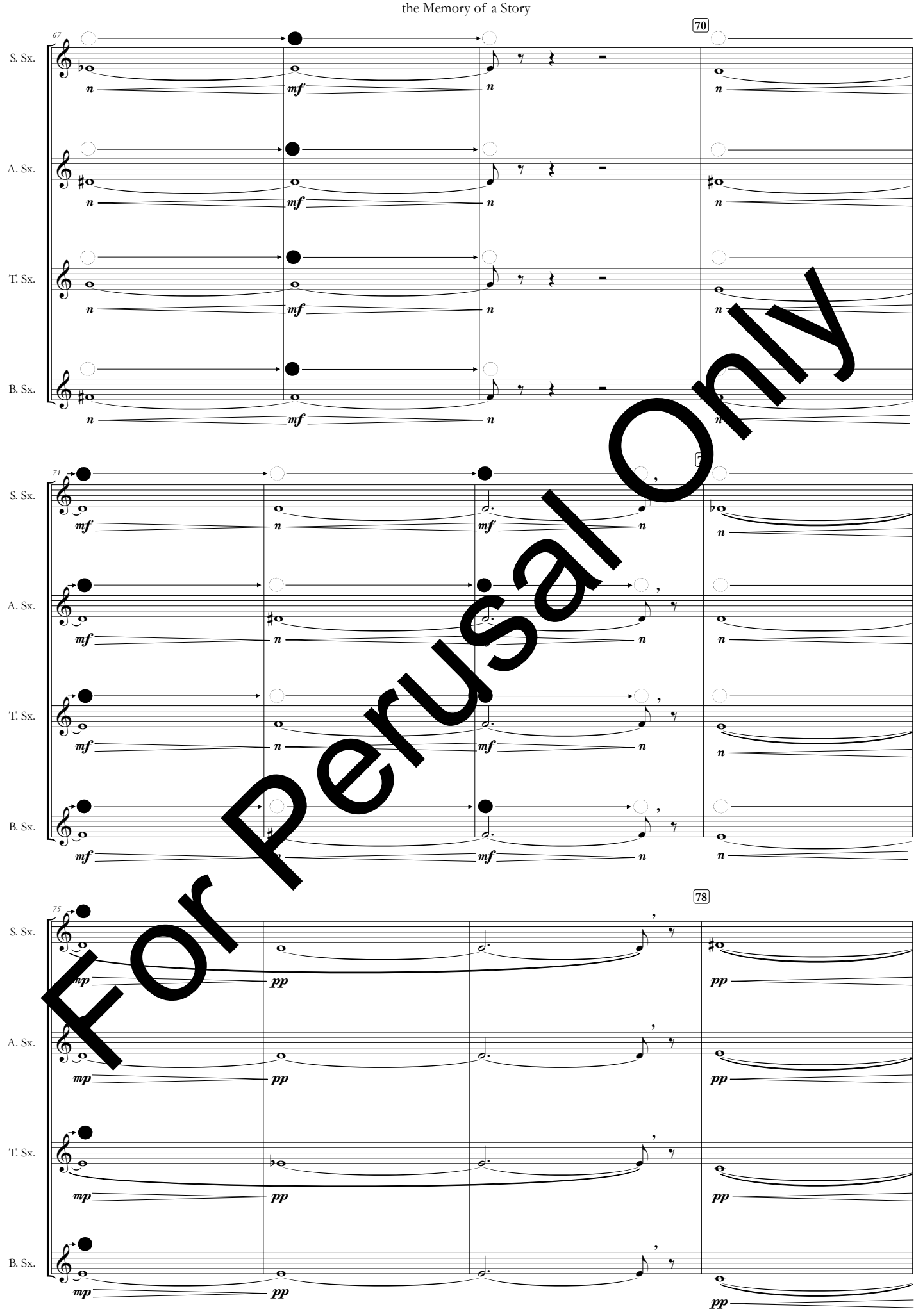

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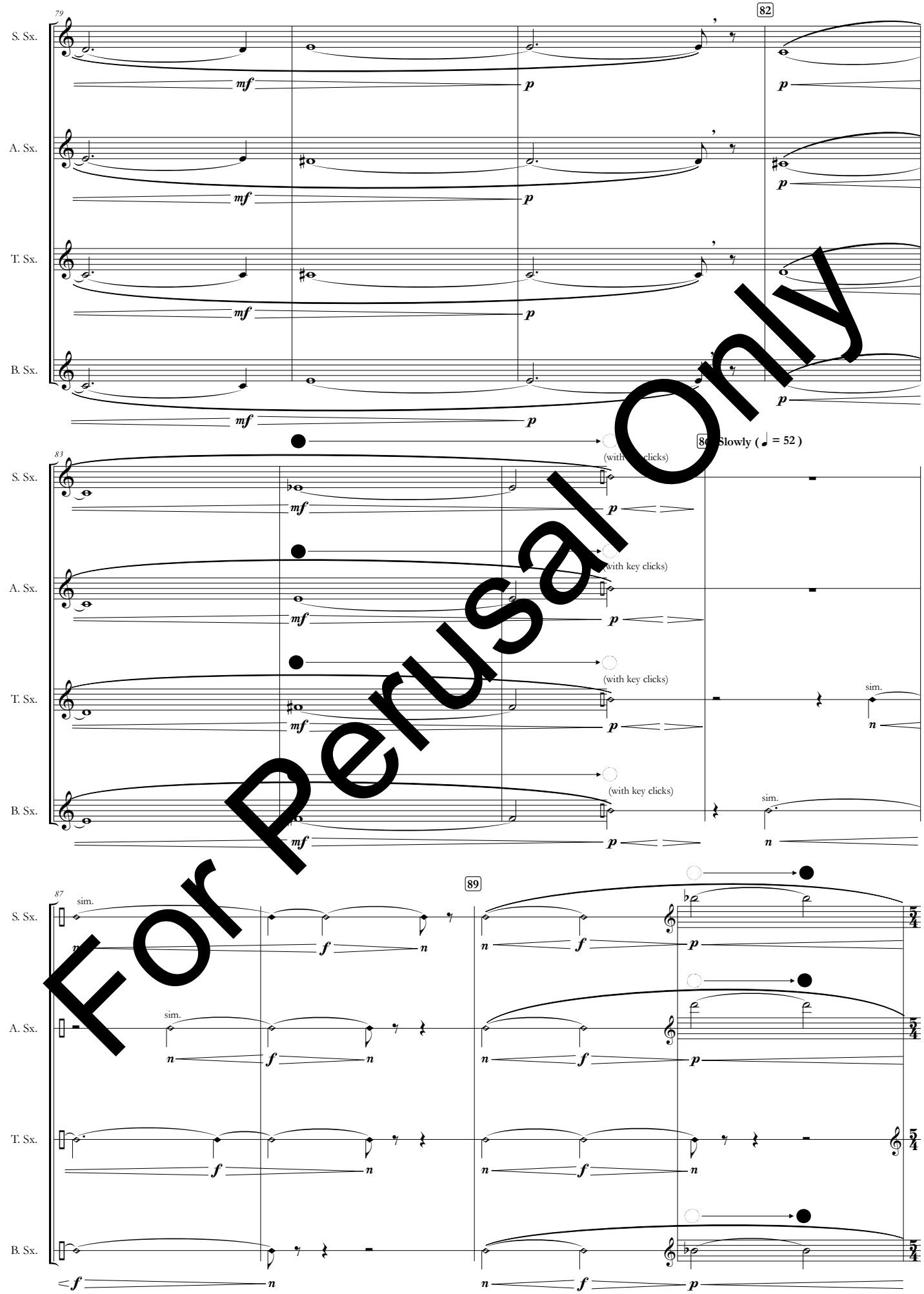

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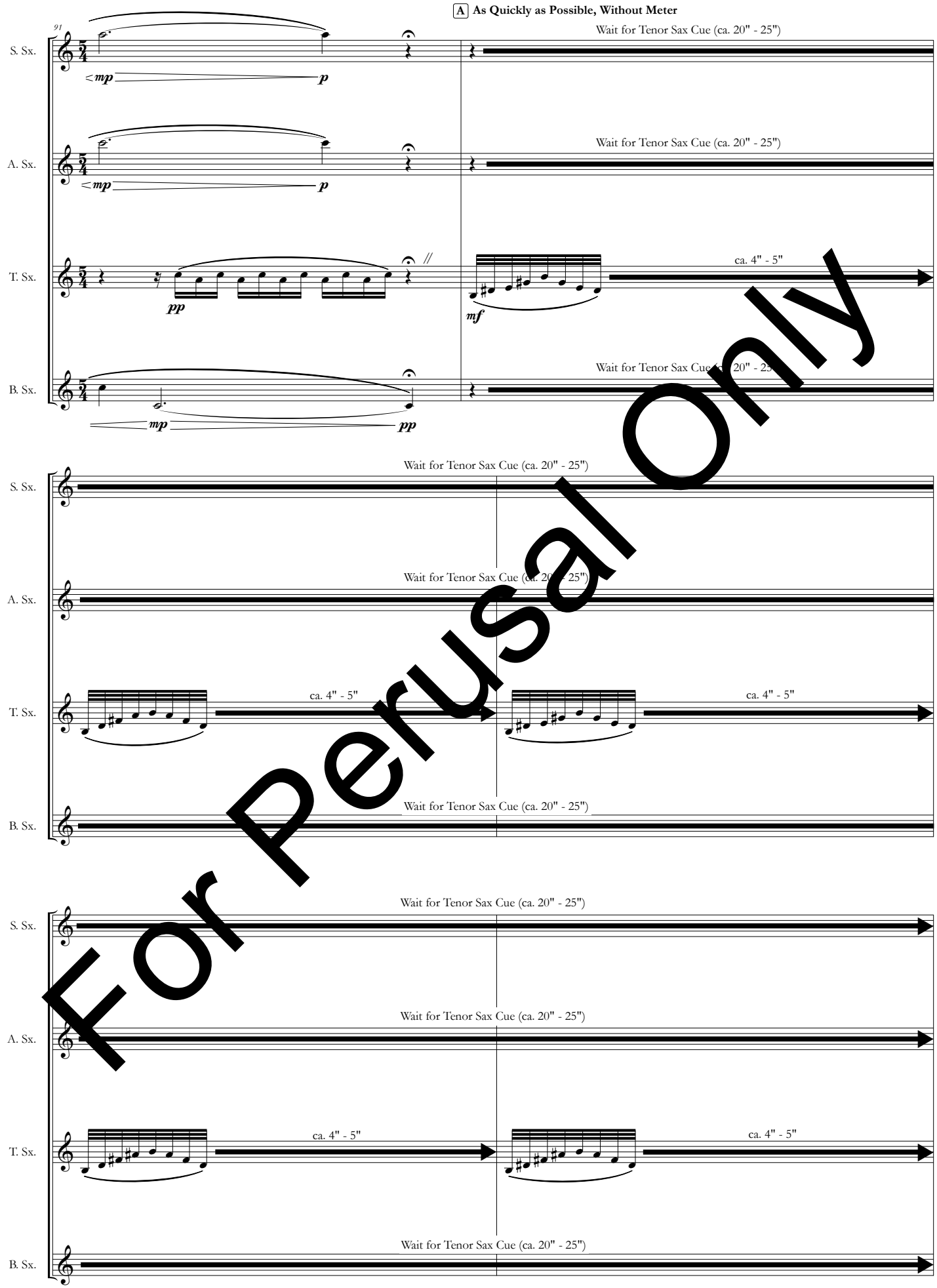

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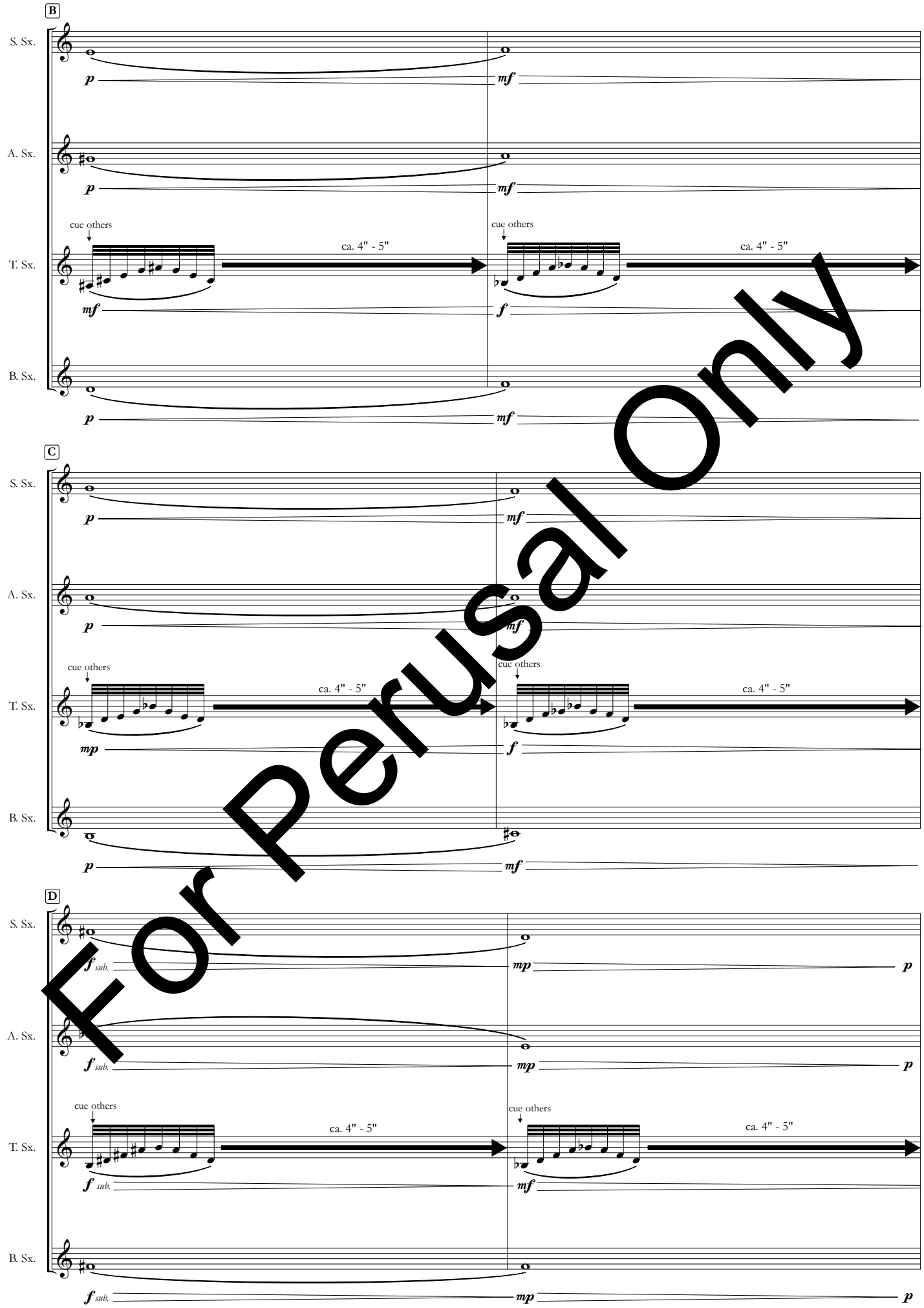

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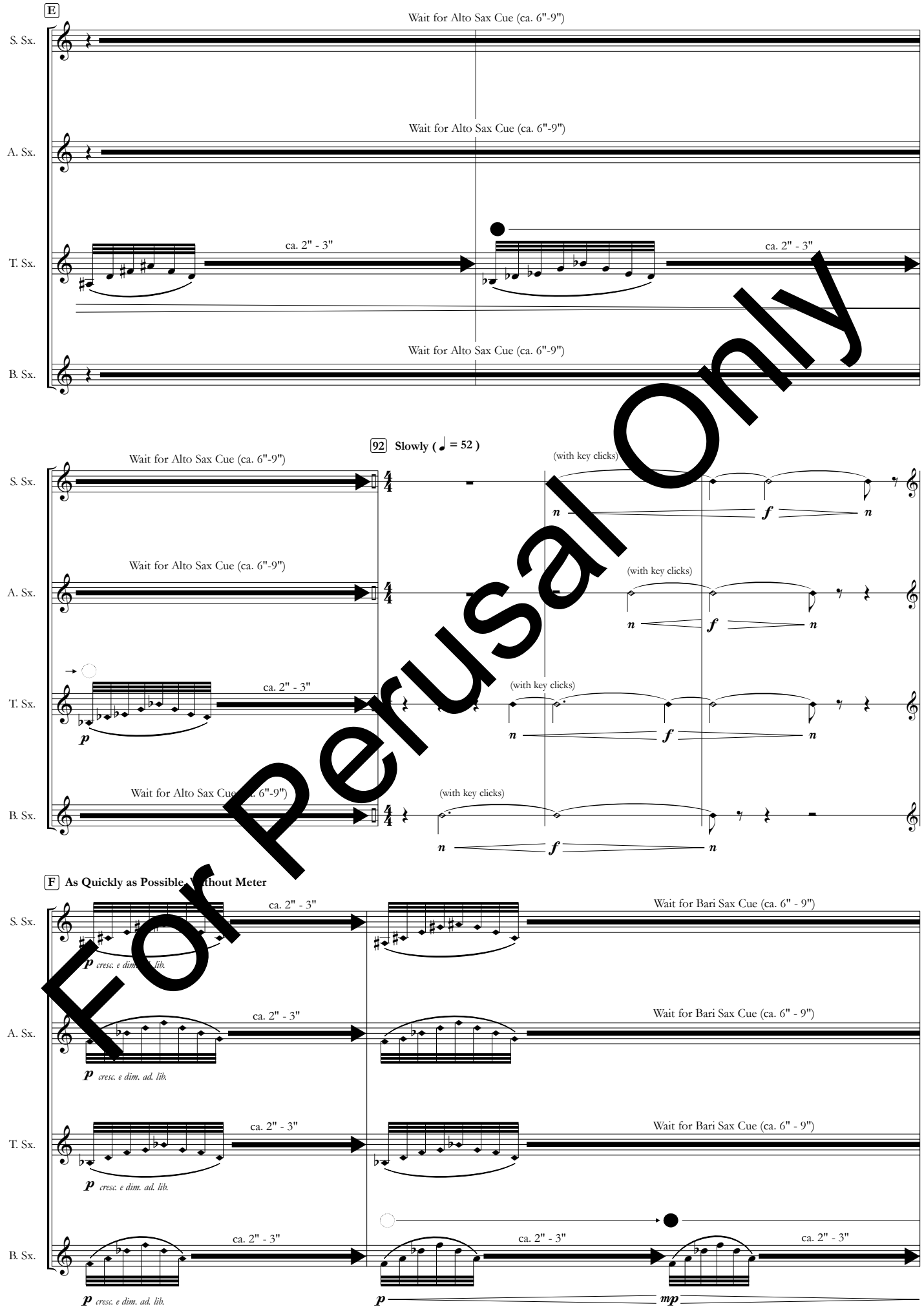

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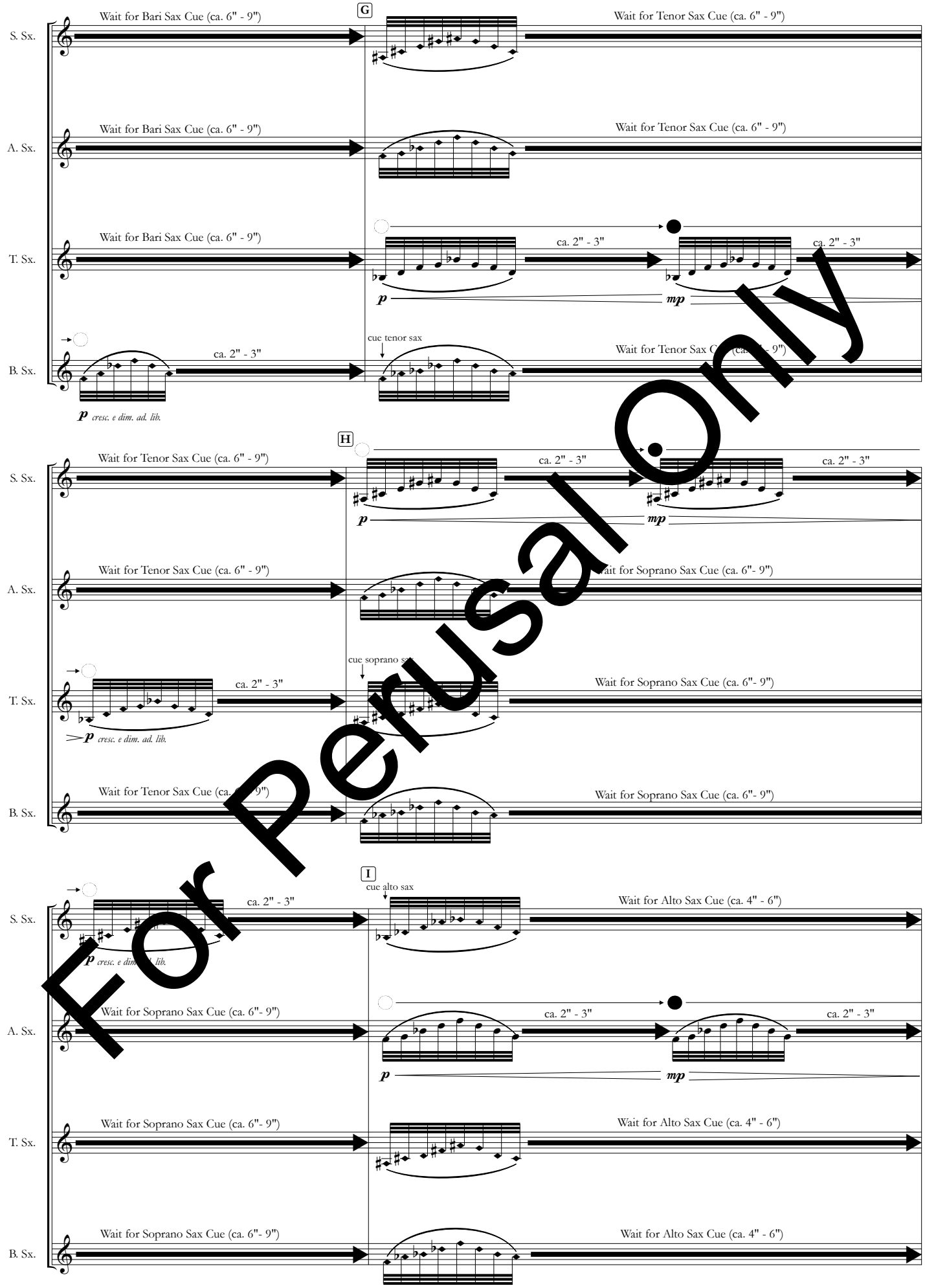

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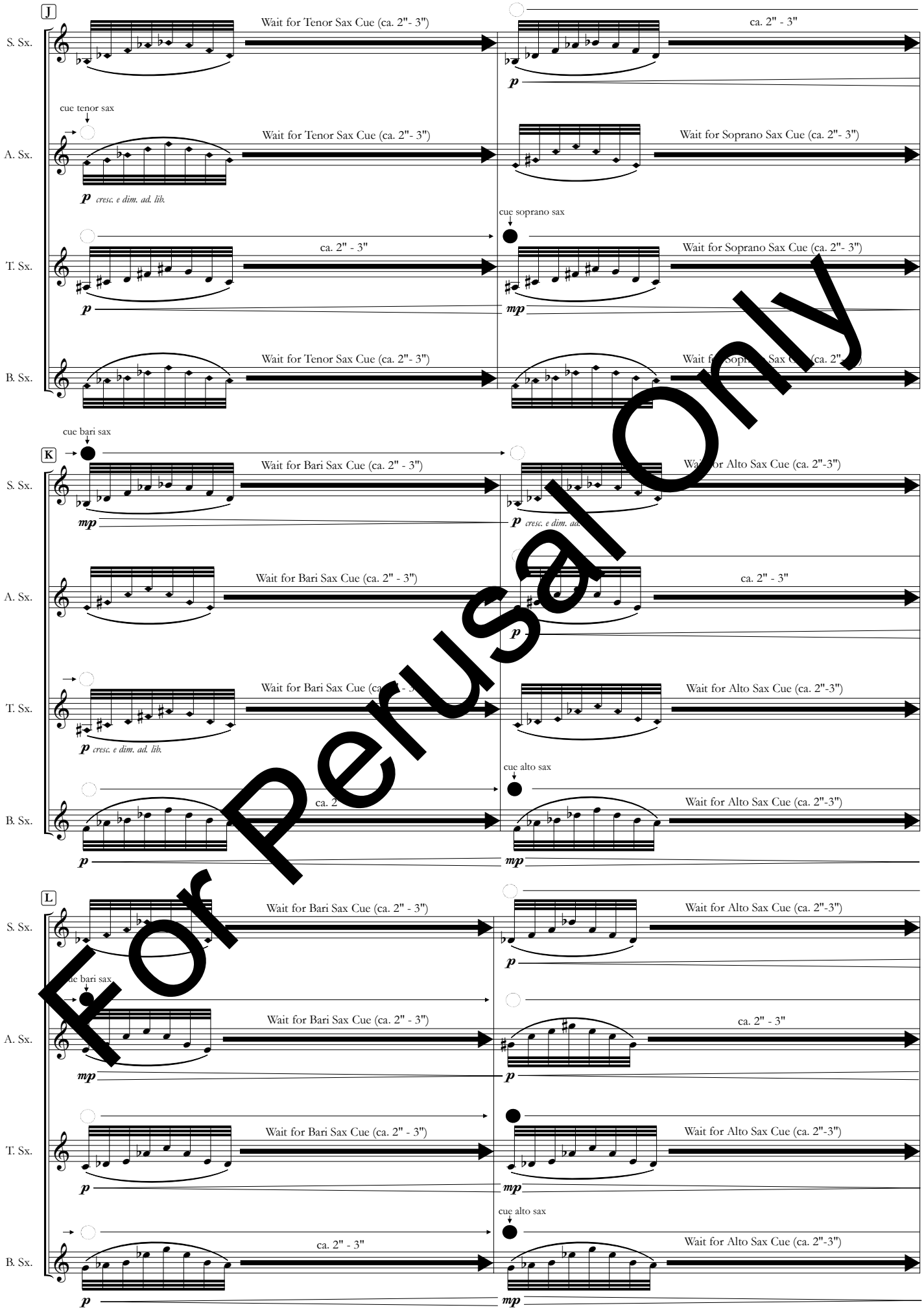

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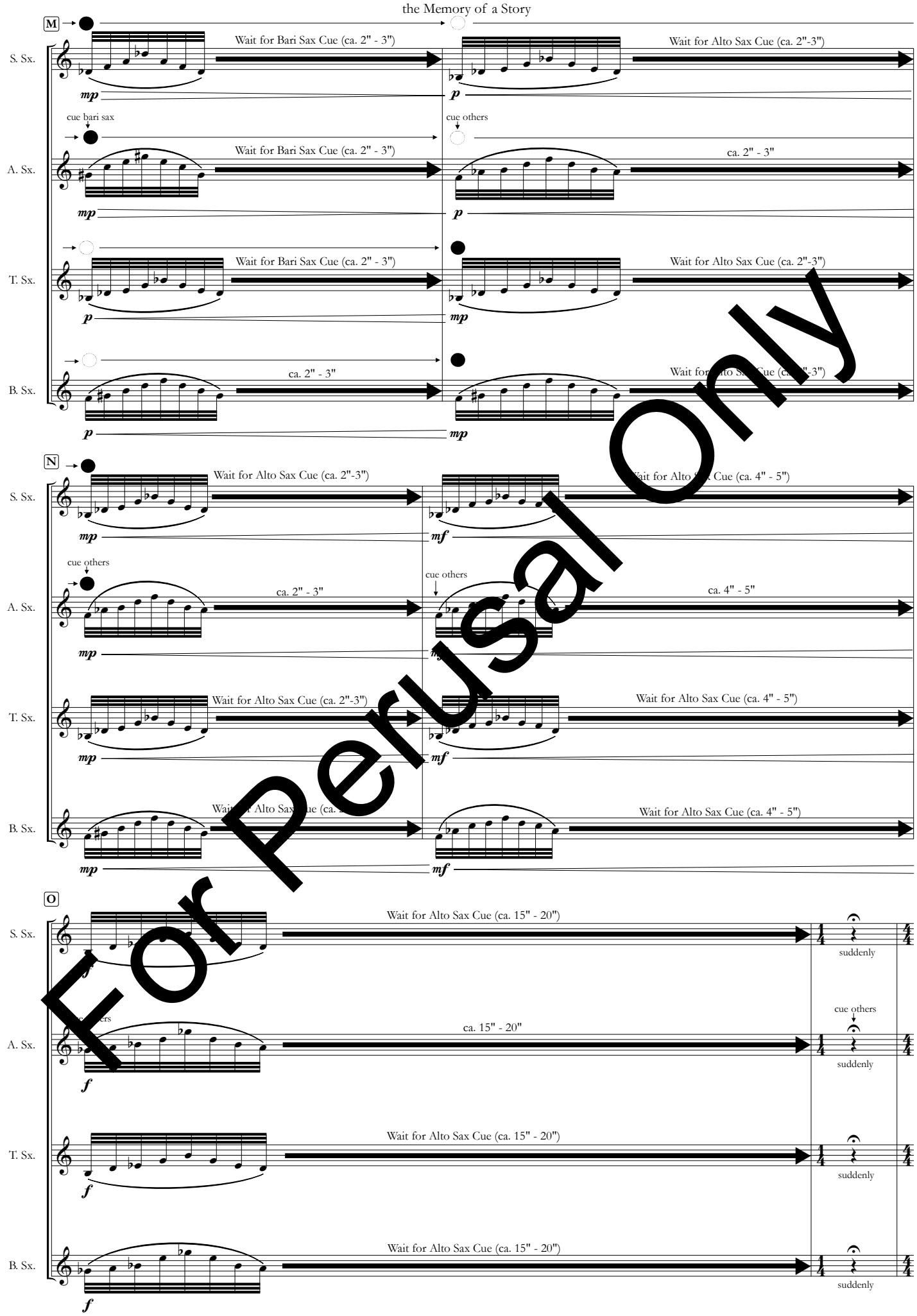

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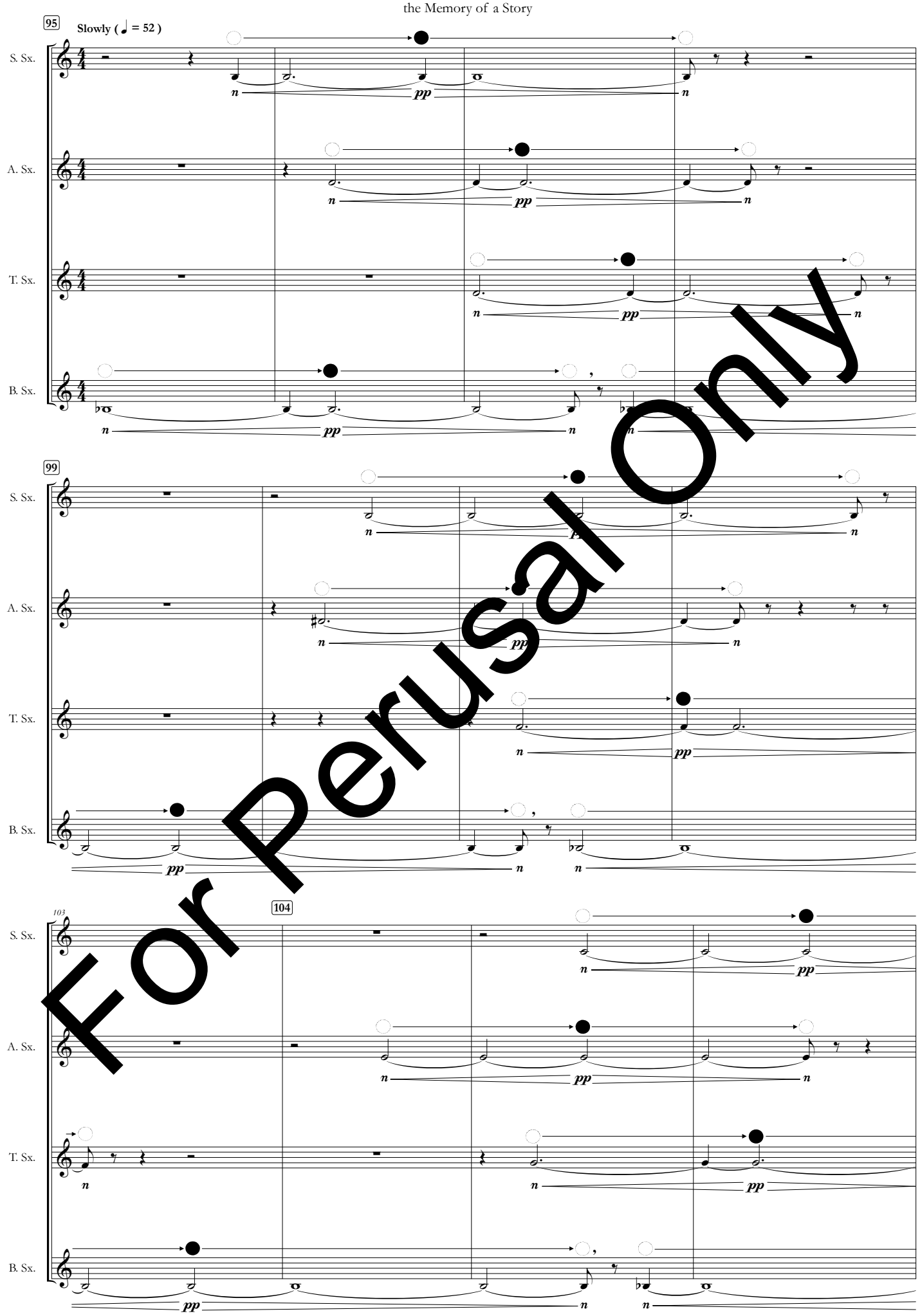

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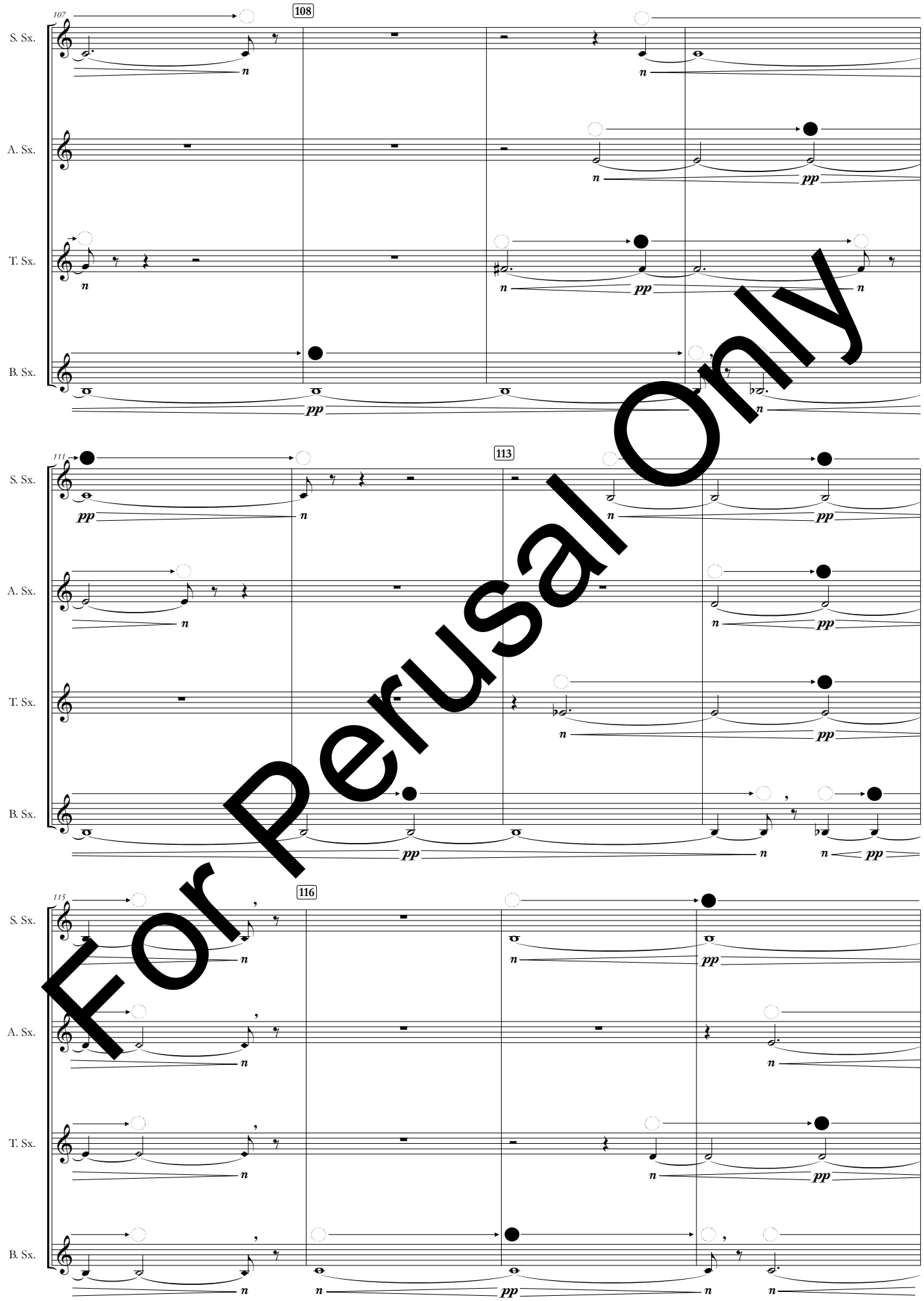

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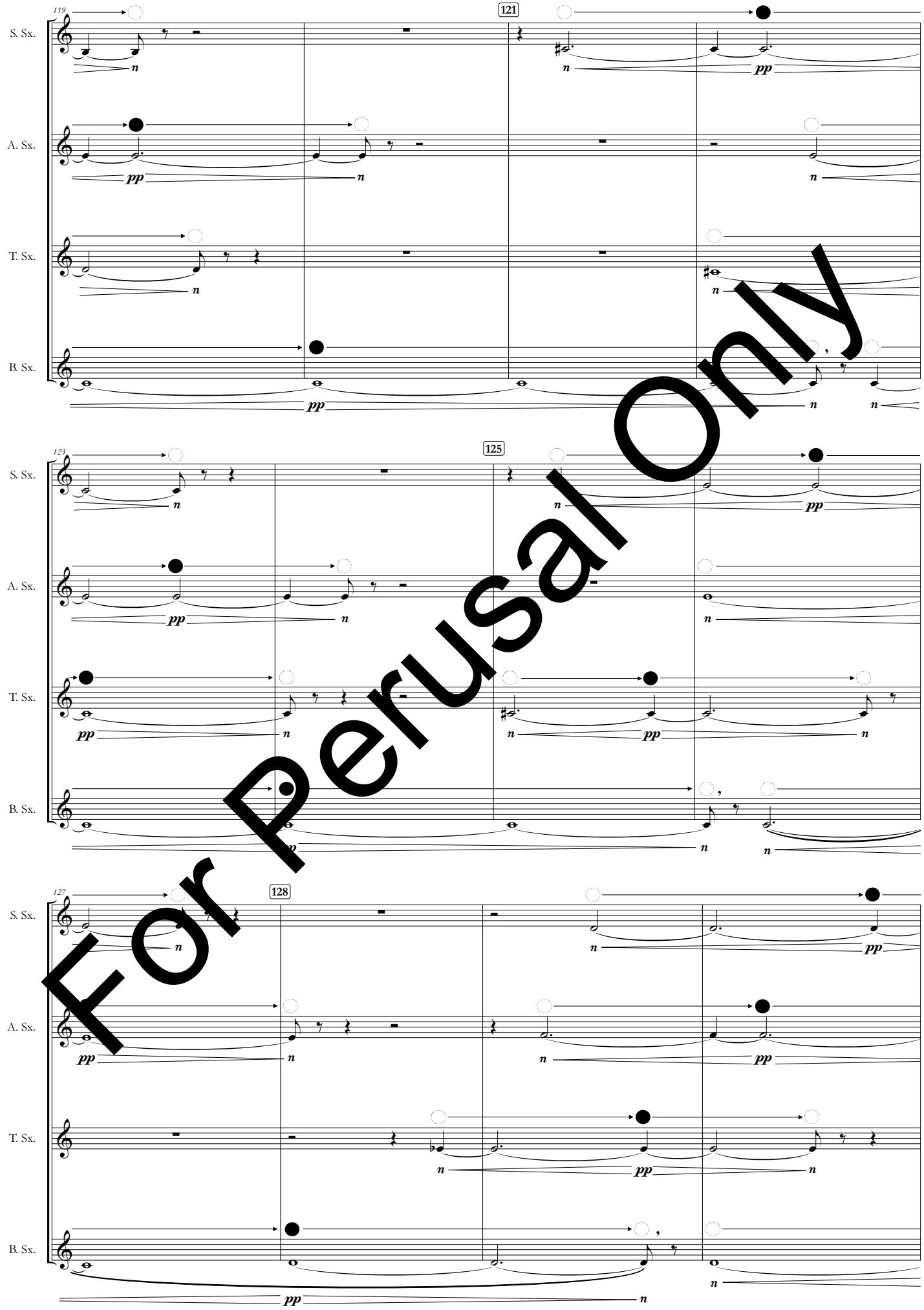

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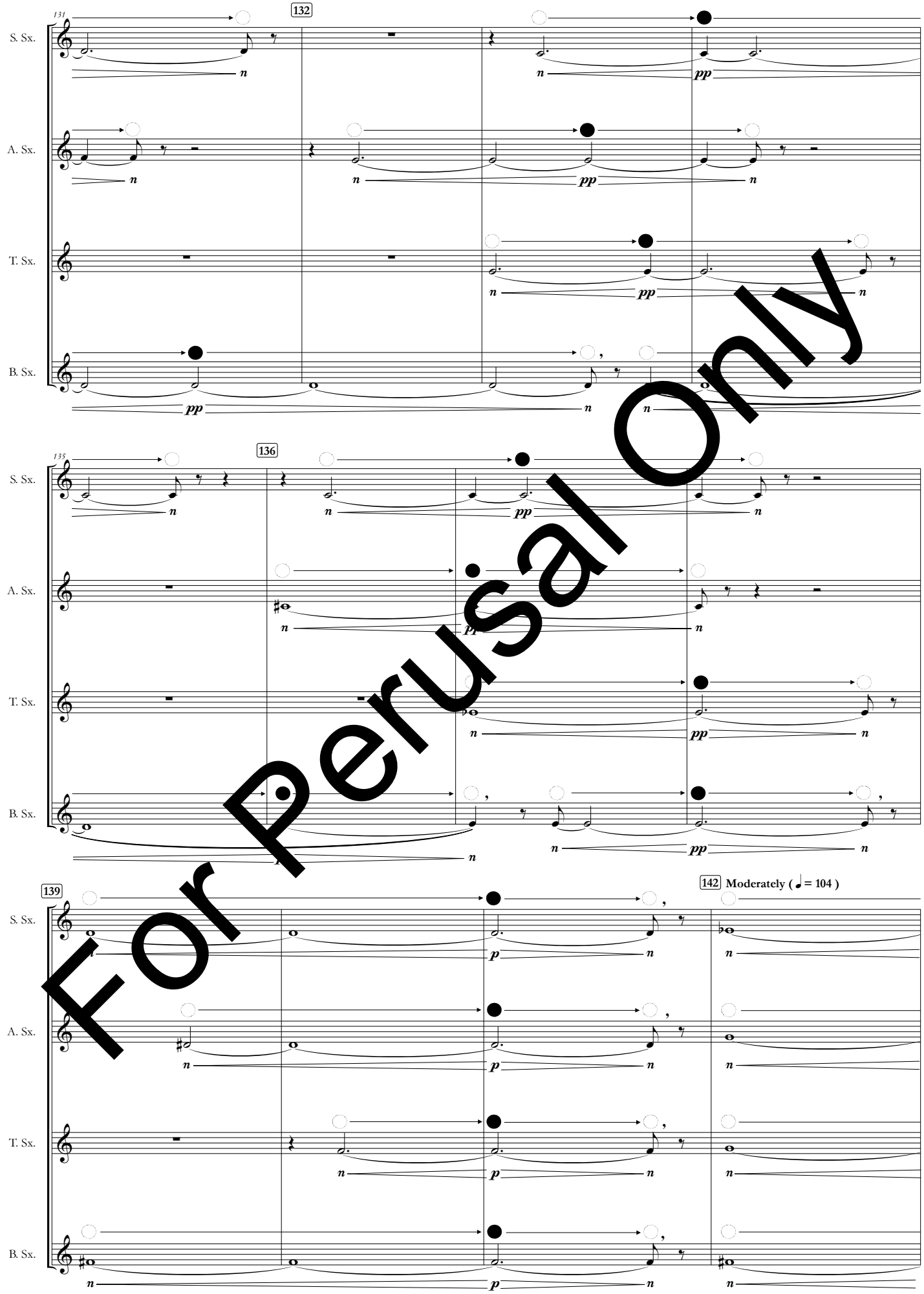

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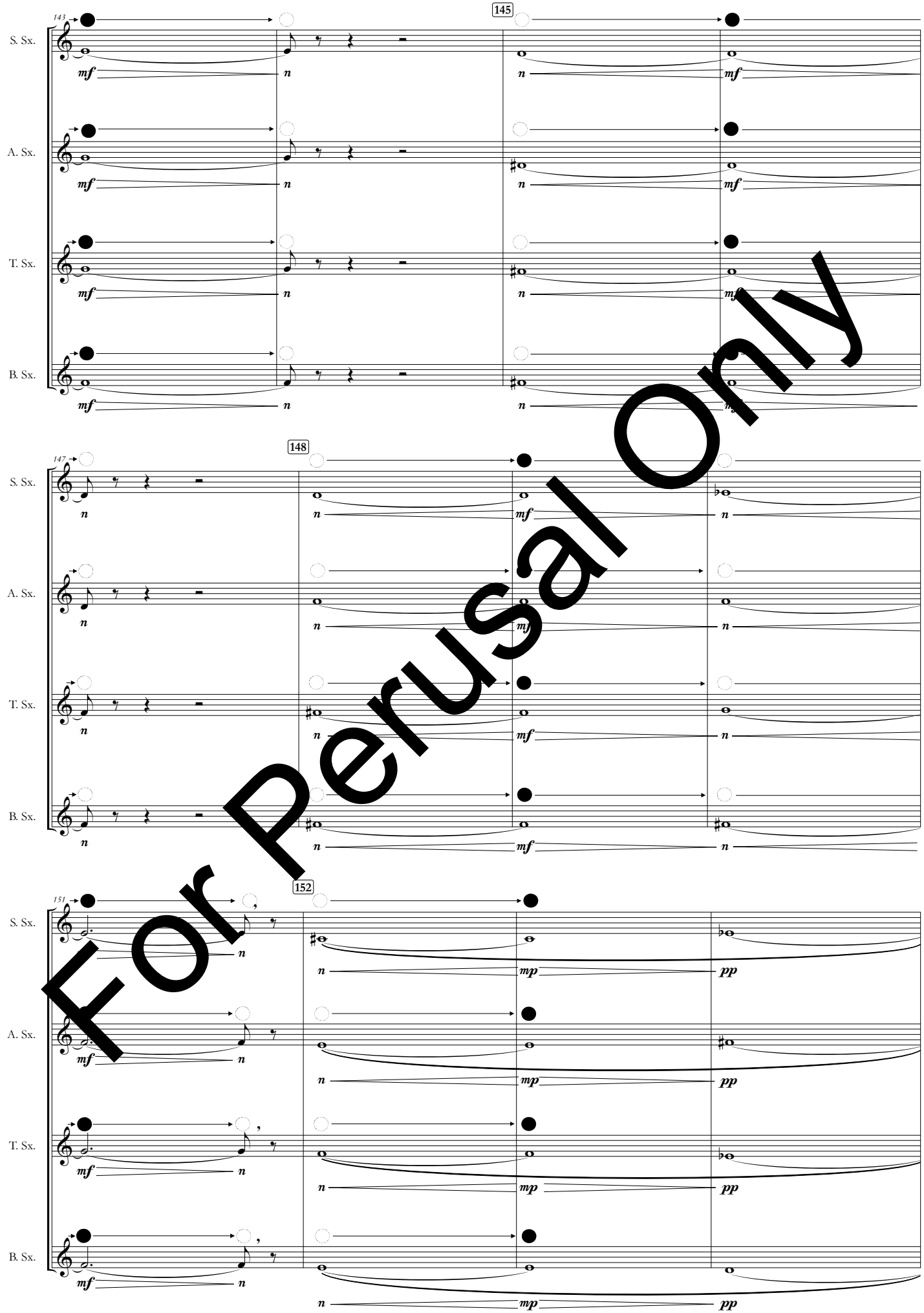

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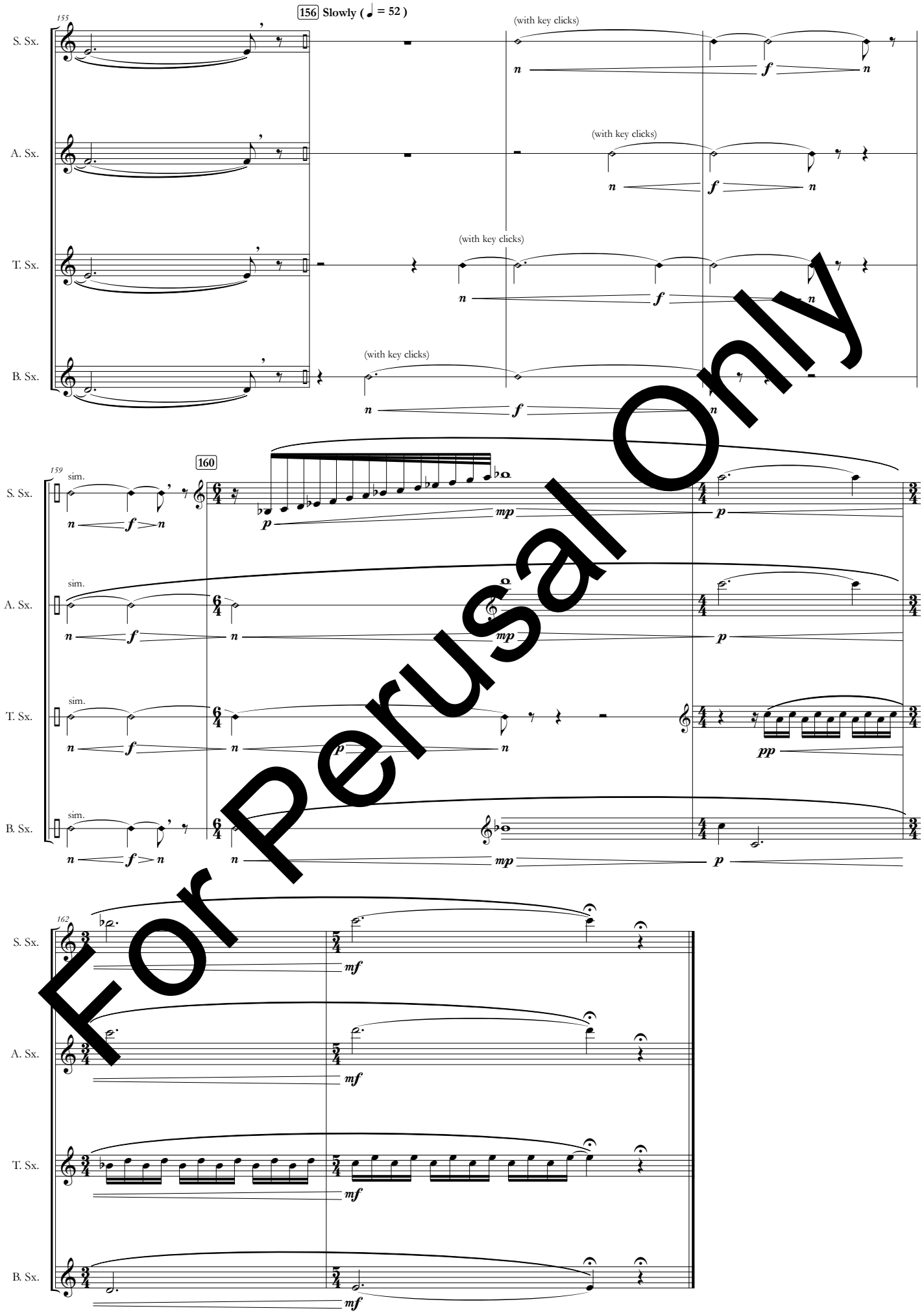

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